Mark Scheme & Model Answer

Exam code: 0475 & 0992

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Mark Scheme and Model Answer

The best way to improve any essay is to know how you are assessed, and what skills you are being assessed on. This page has been created to give you a sense of what examiners are looking for in a full-mark response. It contains:

- Overview
- Mark scheme
- Example task
- Model answer and commentary

Overview

Component 5: Coursework requires you to complete two assignments, each one 600–1200 words in length. You will be asked to explore, or analyse, how a writer has achieved particular meanings or ideas, or to write a piece as a character in a text at a specific moment. Your response must also be supported with direct quotations or close reference to the text.

Mark scheme

Help me understand

The mark scheme for any question in Literature in English is quite broad and can seem difficult to understand. This is because there is no "correct answer" for any essay: the exam board does not provide points that need to be included in any essay; instead, examiners use the mark scheme to place an answer into a level.

The two assignments in the coursework portfolio are equally weighted, and each question tests all four assessment objectives.

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

In simple terms, to achieve the highest marks, this means:

AO1	• Demonstrate your knowledge by incorporating well-selected reference to the text skillfully and with flair in your answers

AO2	• Sustain a critical understanding of the text by showing individuality and insight • This means showing that you understand the main ideas, settings, events and characters, and that you appreciate the deeper meanings of the text
AO3	• Respond sensitively and in considerable detail to the way the writer achieves her/his effects • This means that you are able to explore how writers use language, structure and form to convey impressions and ideas
AO4	• Sustain a personal and evaluative engagement with the task and text • This means that you are able to give a personal response to the question and text, and support your response with references to the text

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Although there are four specific assessment objectives assessed in each assignment, it is not the case that a certain number of marks are awarded for any one objective. Instead, the examiners are looking for a well-constructed and coherent essay that seamlessly combines all of the skills covered by the assessment objectives.

Example task

The following task is an example of one submitted and approved by CIE for a coursework assignment. As we have covered critical responses in the previous revision notes for prose, poetry and drama, the following example is of an empathic task and response. The text chosen is A Streetcar Named Desire by Tennessee Williams:

You are Blanche. It is a few weeks after you were taken to the asylum by the doctor and nurse. You are sitting in your room. Write your thoughts.

Model answer and commentary

Below you will find an example of the start of a top-mark empathic response for the above question:

dearly like a lemon coke with some chipped ice - better still with a little something to mix with it. But I must be good. The kind man is being so nice to me, I must not upset him. I fear he has become a little sweet on me, the dear thing. But I have been fooled before into thinking that I am cared for. Men really are singular creatures. They are only after one thing…

(The Varsouviana polka starts to play softly. Blanche sways and covers her ears. A gunshot sounds and the polka stops abruptly. Blanche moves to her dresser)

The response references moments in the original play and stays true to the character of Blanche

Use of stage directions is in keeping with the author's methods to shed light on the mental state of the character

(Nervously) There, this is a pretty little slip of lace. There's nothing better than a feminine touch to soften a room. I made such a difference to Stella's little apartment with these little touches. She was so pleased with me. We used to dance and laugh, just like the old days at Belle Reve! Stella, Stella, Stella. Stella, for star. How I miss her. I do worry about her, staying with that primate… that brute of a man. Her Polack, without manners or basic decorum. I worry what has become of her and the baby. That poor innocent, being corrupted by the vile swilling and grunting and gnawing of that ape and his bunch of cronies, with no appreciation of art or music or poetry. No, no they just drink and smoke and gamble, and yell and brawl and… and… and I had a lucky escape with one of them. Oh yes. Even though he begged me to save him. Practically on his knees. But no - our backgrounds were too incompatible. And I can never, ever forgive deliberate cruelty. That is the one thing I can never be accused of. So I handed back his roses and bid him farewell.

Specific references to moments in the play and repetition of lines used by Blanche demonstrate knowledge

Key themes are explored and the character's voice is confidently sustained throughout

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